Blueprint

The Inward Bow of a Real-Rooted Polynomial: Newton’s Inequalities, Machine-Checked in Lean 4

Inequalities for polynomials · real-rooted polynomials and log-concavity

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Statements

Theorem 1 — Newton’s inequalities, in Lean 4; Newton.newton_inequality 3

At a glance

What the paper contributes

- A `sorry`-free Lean 4 proof of Newton's inequalities $e_k^2\binom{n}{k-1}\binom{n}{k+1} \geq e_{k-1}e_{k+1}\binom{n}{k}^2$ for real-rooted real polynomials (Theorem 1), and of the log-concavity of the normalized means $p_k = e_k/\binom{n}{k}$; the symmetric-function form assumes p monic, the coefficient form `newton_inequality_coeff` assumes nothing.
- The route is the classical one (Sylvester; Hardy–Littlewood–Pólya): differentiate, reverse, differentiate again, down to a real-rooted quadratic, whose discriminant is the inequality once positive factorials are cleared.
- Four reusable blocks: real-rootedness under differentiation, iterated differentiation and reversal (the constant-term hypothesis dropped), and the coefficient-form discriminant for $\deg \leq 2$, which also absorbs the degenerate case $a_{i-1} = 0$.
- The mathematics is classical; the paper claims the formalization (to the author's knowledge the first in any proof assistant, June 2026), not a new inequality. Equality cases and Maclaurin's chain are named, not proved.

🚀 **Start here: Theorem 1**: Newton's inequalities for a monic real-rooted polynomial, and log-concavity of the normalized means.

Main results:

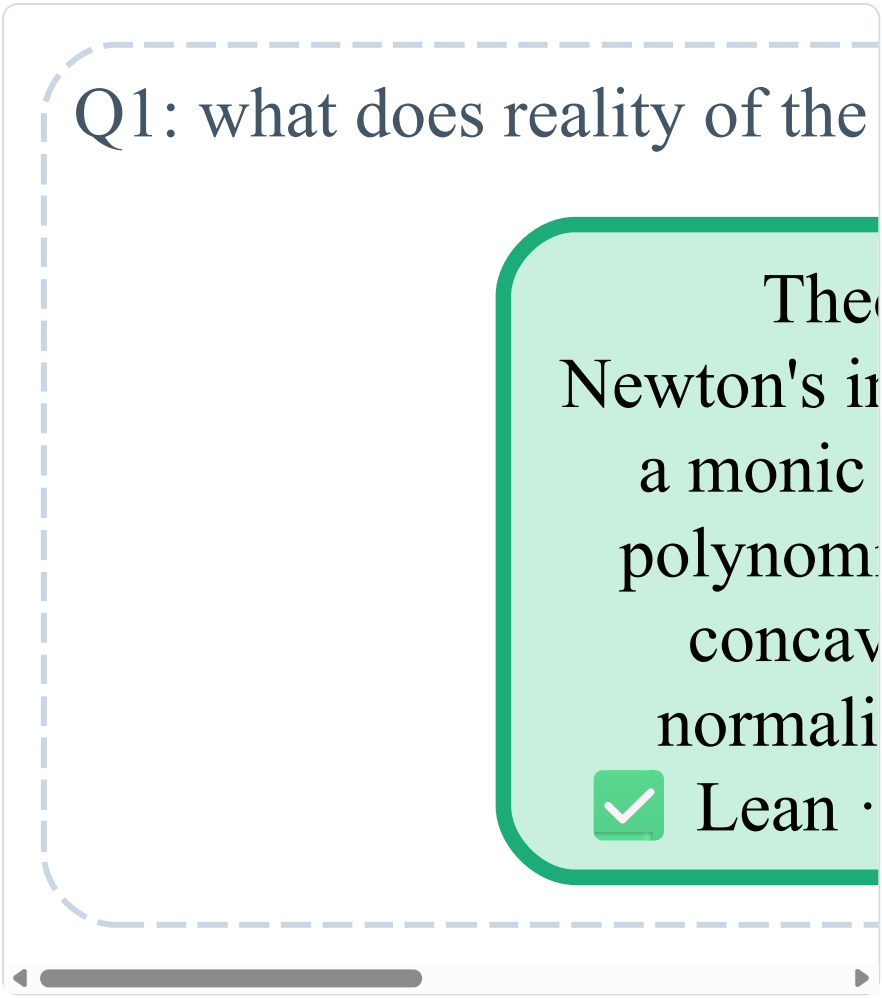
- **Theorem 1**: Newton's inequalities for a monic real-rooted polynomial, and log-concavity of the normalized means

1 results | ✅ **1** formalized in Lean | ◐ **0** with a part in Lean

💻 **1** checked by a program | written proof only | (a result can carry several tags)

🗺️ Map of the results (click a box to go to it)

Dependencies in the written proof: an arrow A → B means that this proof of B uses A. Every result rests on its written proof; the tags record what was checked besides, and each statement's "Evidence & scope" block says how far. The colour of a box is its strongest tag, in the order above; the tags in the box give the rest. Boxes with a thick border are the main results; click a box to read the statement.



1 Q1: what does reality of the roots force on the coefficients?

Theorem 1. Lean **(Newton's inequalities, in Lean 4; `Newton.newton_inequality`)** ✓ p. 2

> *For a monic real-rooted real polynomial p of degree n and every $1 \le k \le n-1$,*
>
> $$e_k^2 \binom{n}{k-1}\binom{n}{k+1} \;\ge\; e_{k-1}\, e_{k+1} \binom{n}{k}^2 .$$
>
> *Equivalently (`newton_logConcave`) the normalized means $p_k = e_k / \binom{n}{k}$ are log-concave, $p_{k-1}\, p_{k+1} \le p_k^2$. Both are `sorry`-free; `#print axioms` on each reports only `propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`.*

✅ Checked when this page was built: NewtonInequalities.lean compiles with Lean 4.35.0, no errors, no sorry. Axioms — newton_inequality, newton_logConcave, newton_inequality_coeff: propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound.

Reproduce: Lean 4.35.0, Mathlib f0b4c8150aa0; in that Lean project, `lake env lean NewtonInequalities.lean` (SHA-256 of the compiled file: `69dd05da620a4eb0…`; a source page on this site may show it with comments edited, under its own hash).

🆕 **Classical and new:** classical: stated by Newton (1707), proved by Sylvester, textbook account in Hardy–Littlewood–Pólya; the paper claims the formalization, to the author's

knowledge the first in any proof assistant (searches of June 2026, §6).

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

Proof

Formalized in Lean (see the linked declarations).

Evidence & scope

- **Program:** the worked instances: e_k of (x−1)(x−2)(x−4), the Newton gaps 21 and 84, the zero gaps of $(x-1)^4$ and the gap −4 of x^2+1 (numpy, with tolerance); script in the paper repository, not in the Zenodo record. `figures/newton_fig1_bow.py`

References

1

I. Newton, *Arithmetica Universalis* (1707); the inequalities among the coefficients of a polynomial with real roots are stated there without proof. 🔎 find it

2

C. Maclaurin, A second letter … concerning the roots of equations, with the demonstration of other rules in algebra, *Phil. Trans. Roy. Soc. London* **36** (1729) 59–96. 🔎 find it

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G. H. Hardy, J. E. Littlewood, G. Pólya, *Inequalities*, 2nd ed., Cambridge Univ. Press, 1952 (Newton's and Maclaurin's inequalities, §2.22). 🔎 find it

4

R. P. Stanley, Log-concave and unimodal sequences in algebra, combinatorics, and geometry, *Ann. New York Acad. Sci.* **576** (1989) 500–535. 🔎 find it

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P. Brändén, Unimodality, log-concavity, real-rootedness and beyond, in *Handbook of Enumerative Combinatorics*, CRC Press, 2015, 437–483. 🔎 find it

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K. Adiprasito, J. Huh, E. Katz, Hodge theory for combinatorial geometries, *Ann. of Math.* **188** (2018) 381–452. 🔎 find it

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C. Marín, *Random Signs into Matchings: A Godsil–Gutman Identity, Formalized in Lean 4*, Zenodo, 2026. `doi:10.5281/zenodo.20517350`.

8

C. Marín, *Unfolding a Graph into a Tree: A Machine-Checked Proof of the Heilmann–Lieb Theorem in Lean 4*, Zenodo, 2026. `https://github.com/karlesmarin/godsil-gutman-lean`. 🔎 find it

9

The mathlib Community, The Lean mathematical library, in *CPP 2020*, ACM, 2020, 367–381. 🔎 find it